Allan Zelsman

Senior Lead UX Designer

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Summary

Principal Experience Architect and AI Systems Strategist designing human-aligned AI product systems that turn complex domains into clear, trustworthy decisions. I define interaction architectures, behavioral signals, and multi-agent patterns so intelligent experiences behave predictably and align with human intent. Recent work includes compressing discovery cycles from weeks to days, unifying account and authentication experiences across 21 brands, and driving systemic workflow redesign that improved onboarding and transaction success by 40%.

Skills

Principal Experience Architecture · AI systems design · Interaction architecture · Multi-agent workflow architecture · Behavior modeling · Experience modeling · Responsible AI patterns · Identity & trust UX · Cognitive load reduction · Complex systems design · Product strategy · Research synthesis · Cross-functional leadership

Experience

UX Agentic – Founder & Executive Director of Experience Design (Jun 2025 - Present)

- Lead an experience innovation and AI-systems practice, partnering with product and brand leaders to bridge human intention and machine reasoning—improving clarity, velocity, and strategic decision-making.
- Designed AI-assisted research and design workflows for rapid pattern recognition and synthesis—using Figma and modern design tooling to prototype, test, and iterate in a data-informed way, compressing discovery timelines from weeks to days.
- Took a Human+AI, consumer-facing experience from concept to live, purchasable system in approximately one month—spanning brand promise, visual identity, persona and story design, kid-safe rails, and an accessible, responsive web experience built with semantic HTML/CSS/JavaScript.
- Established the Experience Modeling Framework as a contract-driven orchestration discipline, governing handoffs, drift controls, and structured outputs powering real-time conversational interaction with business intelligence systems.
- Developed AI interaction patterns and LLM behavior models with trust, inclusivity, and safety constraints to ensure predictable, emotionally safe Human+AI experiences.

American Family Insurance – Senior UX Strategist (Aug 2022 - Jul 2025)

- Supported design-led service improvement that helped propel customer satisfaction from #22 to #1 in J.D. Power rankings within 12 months and sustained top-tier status for the last three years.
- Pioneered early use of AI and synthetic users to stress-test quoting, policy, and authentication workflows—combining user research and usability evaluation with AI-assisted analysis to expose edge cases and failure modes and inform interaction patterns for future intelligent assistance.
- Led UX strategy for a multi-channel digital sales platform in a regulated domain—using Figma to prototype and iterate in a data-informed way on quoting and policy conversion journeys while supporting broader customer experience gains.

- Architected a token-based, multi-brand enterprise design system that reduced implementation time and unified interaction, visual, and WCAG/Section 508–informed accessibility standards across responsive web and native mobile experiences in partnership with front-end engineering teams.
- Defined decision rules and experience guardrails across product, security, and engineering constraints for account, access, and identity spanning 21 brands—helping cross-functional teams make empathetic, inclusive decisions around risk, trust, and customer impact.

Independent Consultant – Principal Consultant, Product Strategy (Nov 2017 - Aug 2022)

- Designed a mission-critical emergency response experience for McMurdo—translating brand promise into high-clarity incident and responder workflows where speed, trust, and comprehension under pressure matter most.
- Led brand and product experience engagements for B2B SaaS and consumer internet clients—aligning visual identity, messaging, and in-product UX so the story customers saw in the brand matched what they felt inside the product.
- Created story-driven page flows, responsive web experiences, and interaction patterns—using Figma and modern design tooling—to turn abstract value propositions into clear journeys across marketing sites, onboarding, and in-product moments.

CGI Federal – Senior User Experience Consultant (Sept 2015 - Nov 2017)

- Led a high-risk legacy redesign for a change-resistant user base, untangling years of feature bloat and dense operational data into clearer workflows and decision pathways.
- Co-led creation of a 508-compliant design system and front-end component library in partnership with engineering, translating UX patterns into reusable HTML/CSS/JavaScript components for Angular and React implementations.
- Reduced time-to-competence and support burden by clarifying workflows and decision logic—where prior mastery required 3–6 months and senior associates spent approximately 60% of their time unblocking others.
- Improved transaction success and onboarding efficiency by 40% through systemic workflow redesign that reduced cognitive load and clarified decision points.
- Served as Product Owner for the team’s primary initiative, defining scope, sequencing releases, and aligning Product, Engineering, and stakeholders across delivery constraints and customer impact.

Previous Experience – USPTO, Ontuitive, Focus, AOL, Vocus (2001–2015)

- Led UX for regulated, enterprise-grade workflows and validated designs against accessibility requirements (Section 508 / WCAG), partnering with engineering to ensure implementation fidelity.
- Delivered end-to-end UX artifacts (research synthesis, personas, workflows, wireframes, prototypes) and translated decisions into backlog-ready requirements for agile delivery.
- Worked hands-on across the design-to-build boundary using semantic HTML and front-end fundamentals (HTML/CSS/JavaScript) to support interactive prototypes and implementation alignment.
- Managed and mentored designers and developers across Focus, AOL, and Vocus on consumer internet and B2B SaaS products, leading 3–5+ direct reports and cross-functional teams from concept through launch.
- Established operating rhythms for execution (prioritization, reviews, stakeholder alignment) and created the documentation trail (epics, stories, and decisions) required for predictable delivery.

Education

BFA, Kansas City Art Institute — Video & Film (Animation emphasis)